

realitybites

"Next year I hope a lot of people in the audience will be taking their notes on a Tablet PC"



Microsoft chairman Bill Gates speaking at Comdex 2001 on his vision of the pen-driven Tablet PC which will have its own version of Windows XP

With the kind of brute force the software giant has, the next thing you know your toaster oven will support XP too!

"While we know the experience won't be as good (with a PC), we will probably look at that down the road"

Apple chief Steve Jobs on the future of the iPod which is supported only on the Mac

After all, how far can sales go when you target only 20 per cent of computer users in the world?

"After careful deliberation... and consideration of developments since the announcement of the merger, I have decided to vote against the transaction,"



Walter Hewitt, descendent of HP co-founder William Hewitt after he originally voted in favour of the HP-Compaq merger.

Dilute share prices with the merger or suffer a \$675 million break-up fee. You're swimming upstream either way.

Ring tone legal issue

One can easily understand the concerns of the record industry over the MP3 phenomenon. Since the courts have rested in favour of the music biz, you'd think they might rest easy for a while, right? Wrong! Record labels now have their



sights set on the booming ring tone industry. With over \$300 million worth of ring tones sold in Japan alone, it's no doubt that this is a surprisingly booming business. The majority of ring tone material sources from copyrighted music, but don't expect anything even close to music from a 'bleep-bloop' cell phone.

"Set your phasers for stun.."

It's not *Star Trek* but it might just be as effective. The Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL) in New Mexico, USA, has devised a new non-lethal weapon designed to heat the skin of its target. Using focused microwaves, Active Denial Technology (ADT) uses a 2-metre dish to shoot out these waves, which AFRL claims only penetrate 0.3 mm into the skin's surface and heats it to around 45°C. But there is suspicion that even brief exposure to the weapon's beams can be harmful.

thermometer



Hot Gaming consoles

With the release of X-Box and Gamecube, revenues are expected to skyrocket between now and 2005

Windows XP

It's the fastest selling version of Windows ever

Cold Broadband

Despite its obvious advantages, subscriber growth in India is very low

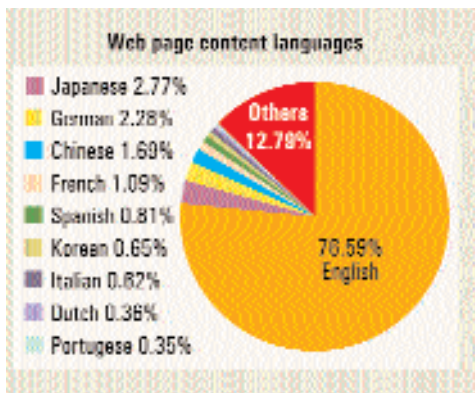
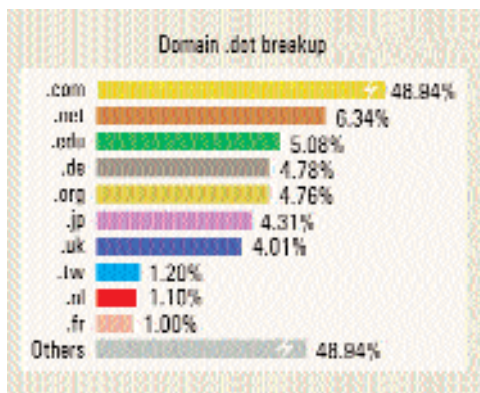
Excite.com

After paying \$7.8 billion for it, Excite@Home sold the loss making porting for a scanty \$10 million.

thumbnail

The Web Wide World

The popular suffixes for domain names and the language the Web speaks



Source: www.netstatistica.com

◆ Java-based phones making presence felt in Asia ◆ Bleem shuts down ◆ Sun pushes UltraSparcIII to over 1GHz